



akayza

Keep it in the kasi.

Making South Africa's informal businesses visible, and ready for what's next.

Prepared by Team PR · GKHack26 · 27 September 2026



THE PROBLEM

Everyone wants a piece of the kasi economy



Big retailers are moving into townships



Banks and payment apps are fighting for its customers

Because it's worth about

R900 billion a year



A spaza shop, and its supplier's truck



A builder's site: bricks, cash and trust



The people who run it can't prove any of it



No finance

Savings, family 57%



Bank loan <9%



It runs on cash and word of mouth. 57% use savings and family; fewer than 9% can get a bank loan.



No support

Fund R500m



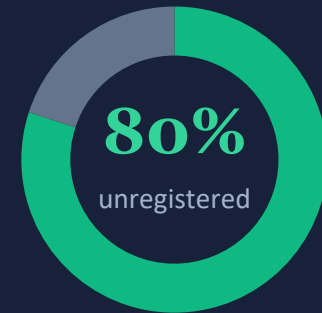
Reached shops R179.6m



Of the R500m Spaza Shop Support Fund, R179.6m reached spaza shops. 354 applications failed verification.



No record



About 80% are unregistered: every order is cash, every dispute is word against word.

A spaza owner can't get stock on credit. A builder can't prove the houses he's built.





One free app for the whole kasi economy



Matched with suppliers who deliver

Spaza shops and food sellers order from the suppliers they use, and ones that fit them.



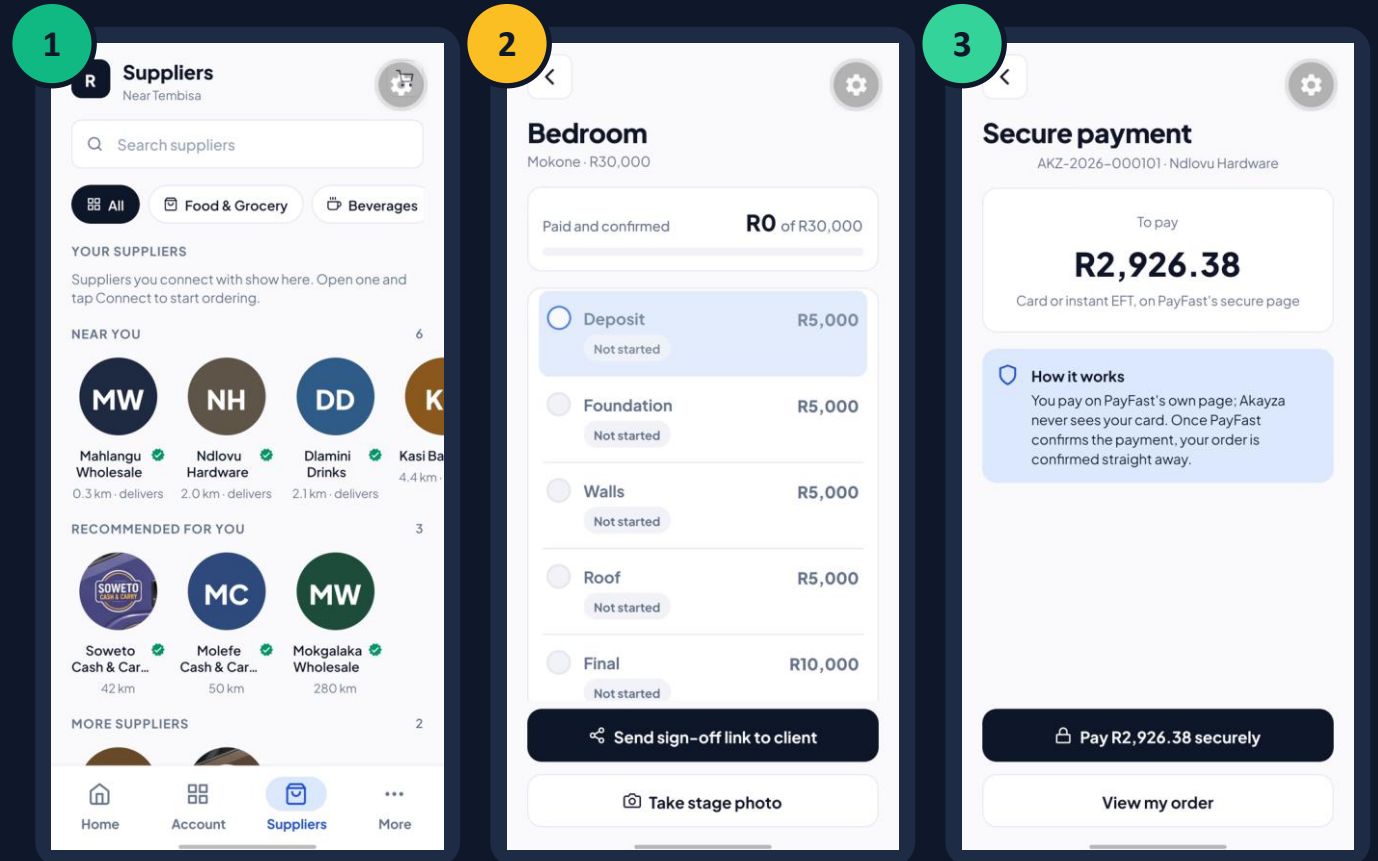
Every job logged with photos

Builders photograph each stage, and the client signs it off from a link.



Payments confirmed

Paid in the app: confirmed by the payment provider. A job stage: confirmed by both sides.



Airtime advance, for business



YOU ALREADY KNOW IT

Your network lends you airtime because it's seen that you always pay.

Akayza builds that kind of history for a business.



Paid orders

Confirmed by the payment provider



Signed-off jobs

Confirmed by the builder and the client

A record the owner holds

Every paid order and signed-off job adds to it. It's shared only with the owner's consent.

The first step to

Credit

Better suppliers

New clients



Meet Sipho and Thabo



On a real phone, against our real system (the full video: 81 seconds)

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1yYQfVBEG-dnn-hxgRRtD5xDVw8vZV8Es/view?usp=drive_link

Watch for

- Sipho picks Food and drops a pin where he trades
- Suppliers who deliver to him
- Bread from a bakery that delivers, paid, confirmed by the provider
- Every kota he sells, in his order book
- Thabo's job: stage photos, signed off by the client

Free for businesses. Suppliers pay.

Starter

R299 /month

Pro

R1,499 /month

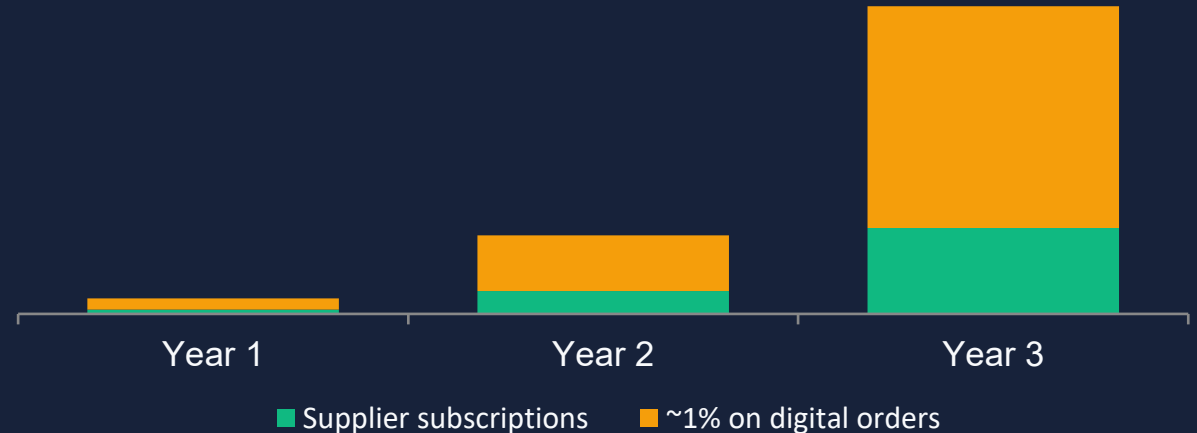
ERP link

R4,999 /month + setup

Digital orders

~1% cash stays free

Monthly revenue at year end (R thousand, estimate)



Y1 ≈ R56k · Y2 ≈ R283k · Y3 ≈ R1.1m a month

15 → 60 → 200 suppliers · 1,000 → 5,000 → 20,000 businesses



Next: lenders pay to see a business's record, only with the owner's consent.



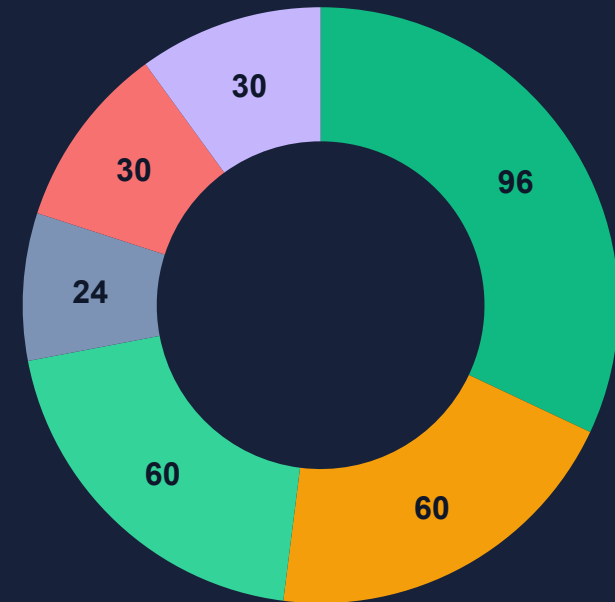
THE ASK

R300,000

for a 6-month pilot: the sum of its costs

- ✓ **2 suppliers** signed and live
- ✓ **50-100 businesses** using it every week
- ✓ **TRL 6** proven in real shops and sites
- ✓ **Break-even** at 2 suppliers on Starter (~R460/month to run)

What the pilot costs: R300,000 (R thousand)



■ Stipends for pilot businesses ■ Field agent
■ Data bundles ■ Running costs
■ POPIA review + security test ■ Devices + contingency

They sell to you. We build your record.

	Runs the business	Your own suppliers	Spaza shops and builders	A record the owner holds
WhatsApp + notebook (today)	no	by voice note	yes	a notebook
A wholesaler's own app (e.g. Shoprite Cash & Carry)	no	one wholesaler	shops	one supplier's orders
Payments / POS (iKhokha, Yoco)	sales only	no	yes	card sales
Bulk buying (Spazapp)	no	their range	shops	their orders
Akayza	yes	any supplier	yes	orders, jobs, payments

Payments are confirmed by the provider, job stages by both sides. And the record belongs to the owner: nothing goes to a lender without their consent.





In the 1950s, Richard Maponya started a milk round in Soweto, delivered by bicycle. His customers trusted him, and decades later he opened Maponya Mall.

The next Maponya is out there right now.

Selling kotas. Running a spaza. Laying bricks.

We don't hold the stock. We build the record.

Keep it in the kasi.

Thank you · R300,000 for a 6-month pilot · Team PR, GKHack26

Everything behind the pitch

The pitch is slides 1 to 10. What follows is the detail, mapped to what the organisers asked for.



Problem statement

Evidence, charts and photos

2, 3, 13



Solution offering

What it is, and how it works

4-6, 12, 15



User journey story

Sipho's week, and Thabo's job

14



Technological architecture

How it's built, and kept safe

18, 20



Competitive analysis

Why we stand out

9



Data privacy policy

What we collect, why, your rights

19



Costs and the ask

Business model, pilot, break-even

7, 8, 23



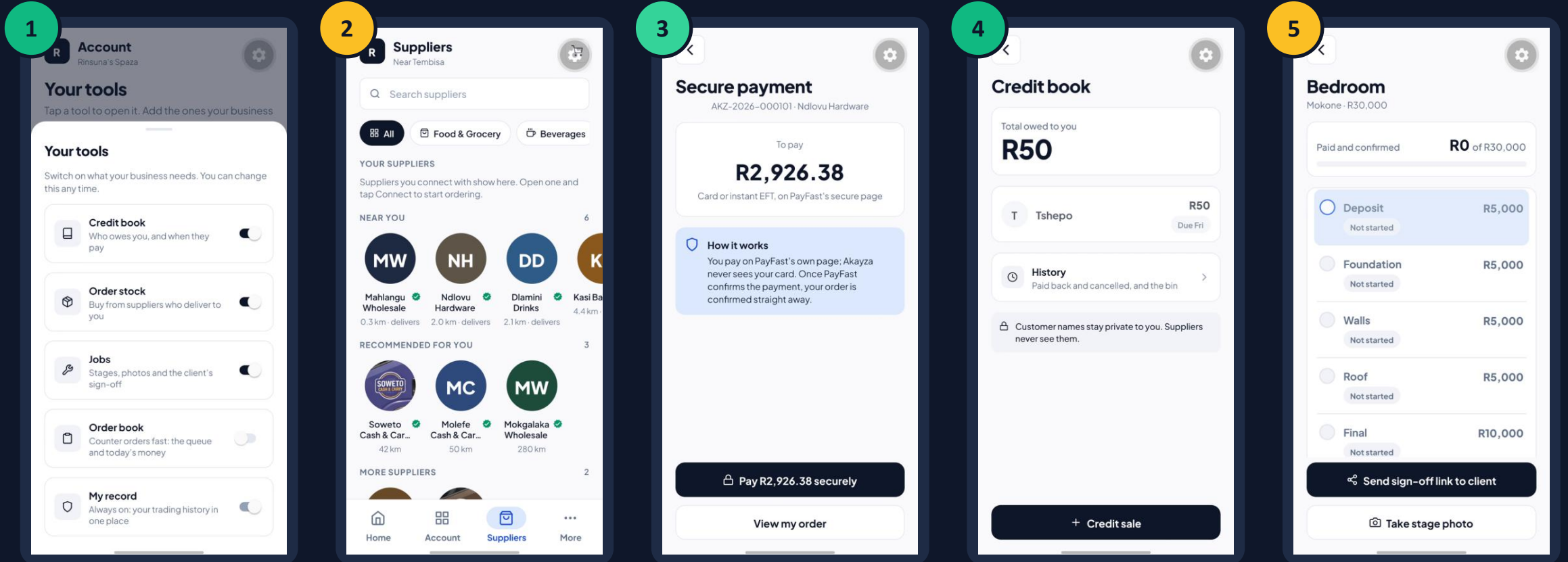
Market and growth

Opportunity, traction, team

16-17, 21-24



One app, at the counter and on site



Switch on the tools your business needs

Your own suppliers, and ones that fit you

Pay on PayFast's page, confirmed by the provider

Who owes you, with customers' names private

A builder's job in stages, signed off by the client



Business tools were built for the formal few

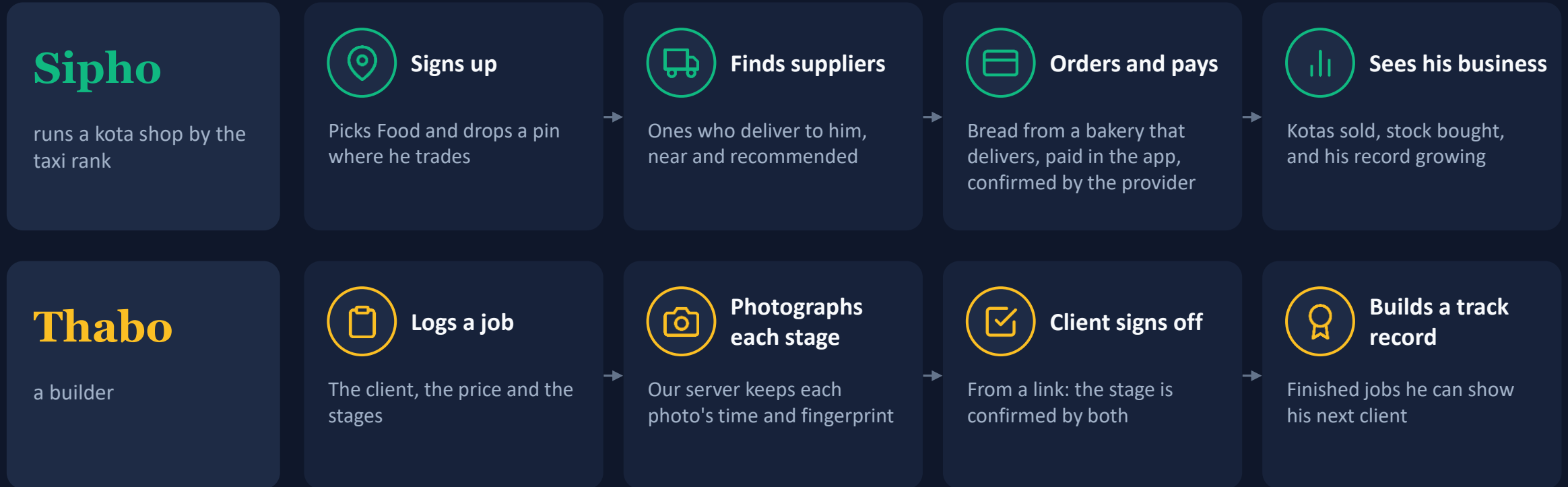
What the tools assume

- ✗ A registered company and a bookkeeper
- ✗ Card machines and bank statements
- ✗ Time at a desk to capture everything
- ✗ One supplier's shop, or a marketplace

How they really work

- ✓ Cash, credit on trust, and memory
- ✓ A phone that's also the business
- ✓ Busy all day at the counter or on site
- ✓ The same few suppliers, for years

Sipho's week, and Thabo's job



The same journey works for a spaza shop, a salon or a mechanic.



Everyone gains. Suppliers pay.



Businesses

Use it free, always

- Less stress, less lost money
- Better buying from their own suppliers
- A record they own, for tomorrow



Suppliers

Our paying customers

- More orders from shops they already serve
- No cash lost between driver and depot
- See what their customers will need



Partners

Next: banks, funds, government

- Businesses they can finally see
- Shared only with the owner's consent
- Faster, fairer verification



Start where the money already moves



R900 bn

The township economy a year: every informal and small business we can serve.

R180 bn

Moves through spaza shops alone every year: one segment, already buying from suppliers every week.

20,000

Businesses and 200 paying suppliers by year 3: about R13 million a year in revenue.



We know this market from the inside



We live it

We grew up in these communities. We know how a business restocks, gives credit and gets paid.



Big and dense

R900 bn, in every province. One supplier serves hundreds of businesses on the same route.



Ready for digital

56% already prefer EFT. Local payment rails and cheap Android phones are everywhere.

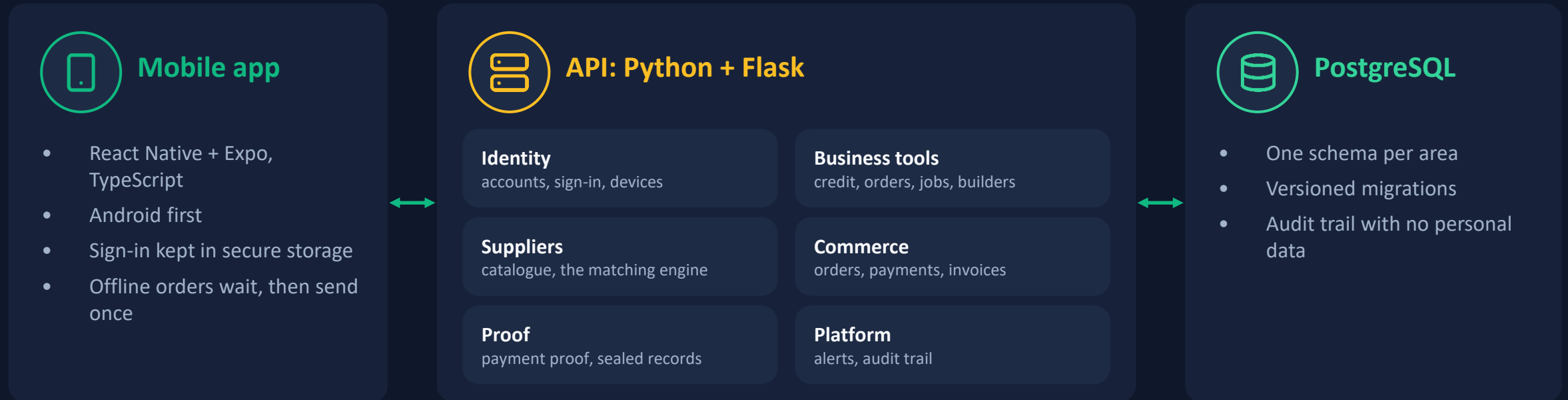


Clear rules

POPIA, CIPC, VAT invoicing: we built to them from day one. Then: the rest of Africa.



How it's built



SERVICES WE USE



On every request: HTTPS, a signed-in token, only the owner's data (anyone else's is 'not found'), strict input checks, rate limits, no double orders, and the server sets every price.



Your data is yours. POPIA from day one.

What we collect, and why

- Email and password (stored hashed) to sign you in
- Business name, type and area the right tools and suppliers
- A CIPC number, only if you choose a badge, checked on the register
- Orders and payment results invoices, receipts and your record
- Your tools: credit book, jobs yours; suppliers never see it

What we never do

- ✗ Ask for an ID number or passport
- ✗ See or store card numbers
- ✗ Sell your data, or use it for ads
- ✗ Show your customers' names to suppliers

YOUR RIGHTS

See and download your data

On our server today; the app button is next

Close your account

In the app today; every phone is signed out

Delete your data

Next. Tax records stay 5 years, by law

If there's ever a breach

We tell you and the Information Regulator



Safe by design, simple to use



Your data is yours

Every request is limited to the owner. Anyone else's record answers 'not found'.



Simple, still safe

Email and password; one code only on a new phone. The rest runs on our side.



No card data

The payment provider's own page. A payment counts only after 4 checks.



Signed links

Invoice, receipt and payment links are signed and expire. A QR check shows no personal details.



Honest proof

Only provider-confirmed payments are proof. The rest is the owner's own record.



Tested like an attacker

Hostile-input tests on every endpoint, rate limits, the OWASP API Top 10.



One supplier brings hundreds of businesses

0-6 months

Pilot

- 2 suppliers
- The 50-100 businesses they already serve
- A field agent at the counter and on the route

6-18 months

Grow

- 15 paying suppliers
- 1,000 active businesses
- Owners invite the suppliers they use

18-36 months

Scale

- 200 suppliers, all 9 provinces
- Business associations, trade events
- Then other African markets

Suppliers are both our customer and our channel: no expensive ads, one relationship at a time.



Not an idea. It's built, and it works.

1,281

automated system tests pass

204

app tests pass

1,672

products from 11 sample
suppliers

0

card numbers ever touch our
servers



TRL 4 · today

Every flow works end to end in our own environment, with real payments in the provider's sandbox.



TRL 5-6 · pilot

Real suppliers and businesses, live payments, in their own shops and sites.



TRL 7+ · year 1

All nine provinces; suppliers' stock systems connected.



WHAT IT COSTS

Small to start. Profitable by year 3.

START

R300k

One-off: the 6-month pilot (the ask)

GROW

~R1.5m

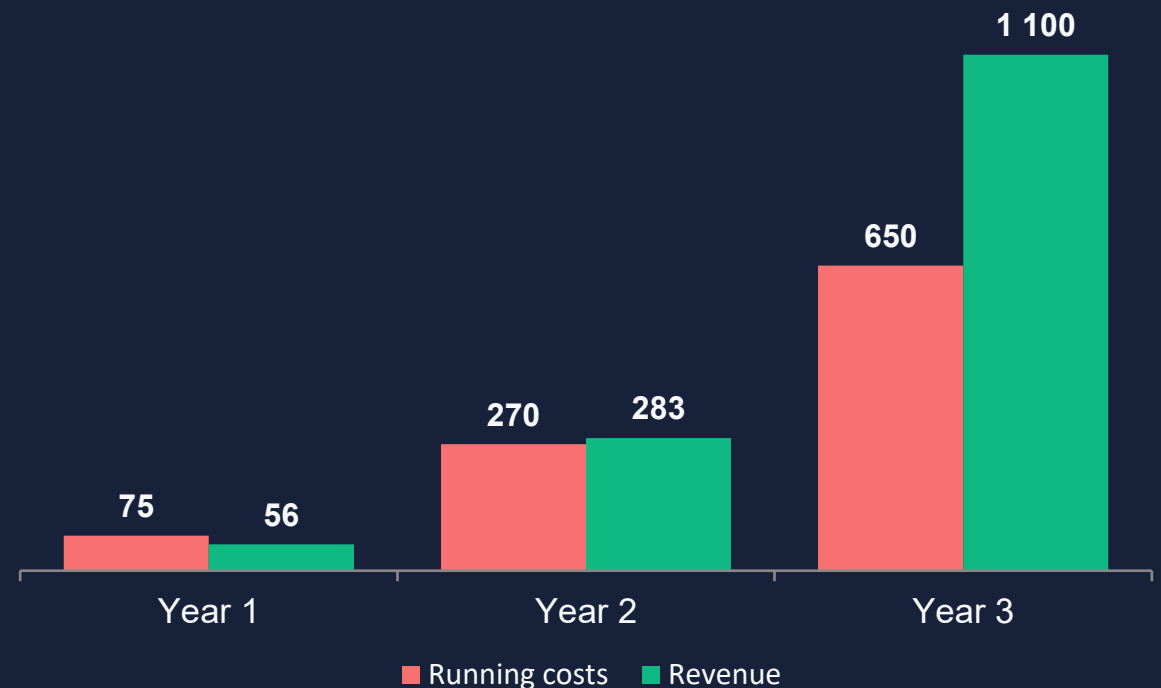
Raised after the pilot, to hire ahead of revenue

BREAK EVEN

Year 2

Suppliers' fees cover all costs

A month at year end (R thousand, estimate)



Most of the cost is people: the team and field agents.



Builders who know the kasi



Mandla

Team lead

Product, backend, payments and the supplier engine



Risuna

Business tools

Credit book, order book, jobs, builder network, notifications

Built this weekend, end to end: the app, the system behind it and real payments, with over 1,400 automated tests.



The road from here

Next 3 months

- Google sign-in, phone push alerts
- Two-phone cash confirmation
- Cloudflare protection on our own domain

Next 12 months

- Direct links to suppliers' stock systems
- Split payouts straight to suppliers
- Share your record with a lender, by consent

Quantum-safe

- Built: the owner seals their record with ML-DSA-65 (NIST FIPS 204) plus Ed25519
- A check shows any record changed or deleted
- Next: invoices and receipts too

